

FreeEnergyConsultants.com — Lead Automation Implementation Guide

Overview & Total Monthly Cost Estimate

This guide walks you through every tool needed to take FreeEnergyConsultants.com from static landing page to fully automated, AI-powered lead generation pipeline. No prior experience with these tools is assumed.

Estimated monthly cost at launch: \$29-\$50/month At scale (100+ leads/month): \$50-\$120/month

Here's the full cost breakdown, followed by step-by-step setup instructions for each tool.

1. Landing Page Hosting — Vercel

What it is: Vercel is a hosting platform where you upload your website code and it goes live on the internet with a custom domain, SSL certificate, and fast global delivery. Think of it as a simpler, developer-friendly alternative to GoDaddy or Bluehost — but optimized for modern websites.

Why Vercel over WordPress/Wix: No plugins to maintain, no security patches, no database to manage. Your landing page is a single HTML file that loads instantly. Vercel also supports "serverless functions" — small backend scripts that run on demand — which is how the AI lead qualification will work.

Cost:

- Hobby plan: **\$0/month** (for personal/non-commercial — fine for testing)
- Pro plan: **\$20/month** per developer (for commercial use — you'll need this)
- Your landing page will use minimal bandwidth, so no overage charges expected

Step-by-step setup:

1. Go to vercel.com and create an account (sign up with GitHub, GitLab, or email)
2. Install Git on your computer if you don't have it (download from git-scm.com)
3. Create a new folder on your computer called `free-energy-site`
4. Put the landing page HTML file inside it as `index.html`
5. Create a GitHub account (github.com) if you don't have one
6. Push the folder to a new GitHub repository
7. In Vercel, click "Add New → Project" and import your GitHub repository

8. Vercel will automatically deploy it and give you a live URL like `free-energy-site.vercel.app`
9. To connect your custom domain (freeenergyconsultants.com): go to Project Settings → Domains → Add your domain and update your DNS records as instructed

What to expect: Your landing page will be live within 5 minutes of your first deploy. Any time you update the code and push to GitHub, Vercel automatically redeploys.

2. AI Lead Qualification — Claude API (Anthropic)

What it is: The Claude API lets your website send text to Claude and get a response back — programmatically, without a chat interface. In your case, when someone submits the lead form, the form data gets sent to Claude with a prompt like "score this lead and write a personalized follow-up email." Claude responds with a JSON object your code can use.

Why Claude Sonnet specifically: It's the best balance of quality and cost for this use case. It's smart enough to write genuinely personalized outreach emails and score leads accurately, but at 1/5th the cost of Opus.

Cost:

- Claude Sonnet 4.6: **\$3 per million input tokens / \$15 per million output tokens**
- A typical lead qualification call uses roughly 800 input tokens (your prompt + form data) and 300 output tokens (the JSON response)
- **Per lead: approximately \$0.007** (less than one cent)
- At 100 leads/month: roughly **\$0.70/month**
- At 1,000 leads/month: roughly **\$7/month**
- You get \$5 in free credits when you sign up

Step-by-step setup:

1. Go to `console.anthropic.com` and create an account
2. Add a payment method (credit card)
3. Go to API Keys and create a new key — copy it and save it securely
4. **IMPORTANT: Never put this key in your frontend code.** It must live on your server (Vercel serverless function)
5. In your Vercel project, create a file at `api/qualify.js` — this is a serverless function that:
 - Receives form data from the frontend
 - Adds the API key (stored as an environment variable in Vercel)
 - Calls the Claude API

- Returns the result to the frontend
6. In Vercel Project Settings → Environment Variables, add `ANTHROPIC_API_KEY` with your key
 7. Update the lead form's submit handler to POST to `/api/qualify` instead of calling the API directly

Serverless function example (api/qualify.js):

```
javascript

export default async function handler(req, res) {
  const response = await fetch("https://api.anthropic.com/v1/messages", {
    method: "POST",
    headers: {
      "Content-Type": "application/json",
      "x-api-key": process.env.ANTHROPIC_API_KEY,
      "anthropic-version": "2023-06-01"
    },
    body: JSON.stringify({
      model: "claude-sonnet-4-20250514",
      max_tokens: 1000,
      messages: [{ role: "user", content: req.body.prompt }]
    })
  });
  const data = await response.json();
  res.status(200).json(data);
}
```

3. Automation Orchestration — Make (formerly Integromat)

What it is: Make is a visual automation platform. You build "scenarios" by connecting apps together on a canvas — like drawing a flowchart, except each box actually does something. When a lead submits your form, Make can automatically: enrich their data, call Claude, add them to your CRM, send an email, and ping you on Slack — all without writing code.

Why Make over Zapier: Make is significantly cheaper for multi-step workflows. Each "operation" (step) counts as one credit. Your lead workflow has roughly 6–8 steps per lead. Zapier charges per "task" at higher rates and doesn't support branching as well.

Cost:

- Free plan: **\$0/month** — 1,000 credits/month, 2 active scenarios (good for testing)
- Core plan: **\$9/month** — 10,000 credits/month, unlimited scenarios

- Pro plan: **\$16/month** — 10,000 credits, priority execution
- Your lead workflow uses roughly 8 credits per lead
- At 100 leads/month = 800 credits → **Free plan works**
- At 500 leads/month = 4,000 credits → **Core plan (\$9/month)**
- At 1,500+ leads/month → **Pro plan (\$16/month)**

Step-by-step setup:

1. Go to make.com and create a free account
2. Click "Create a new scenario"
3. Your scenario flow will look like this: **Trigger: Webhook**
 - Click the "+" button, search for "Webhooks" → "Custom webhook"
 - Make generates a unique URL — copy it
 - In your Vercel lead form, add a fetch() call that POSTs the form data to this webhook URL on form submit

Step 2: Claude API (HTTP module)

- Add an "HTTP → Make a request" module
- URL: `https://api.anthropic.com/v1/messages`
- Method: POST
- Headers: your API key and content type
- Body: your scoring prompt with the lead's form data inserted
- This returns the AI score, tier, savings estimate, and outreach email

Step 3: Router

- Add a "Router" module — this splits the flow based on conditions
- Path 1: If tier = "A" → immediate Slack alert + send email
- Path 2: If tier = "B" → add to CRM + queue email for 1-hour delay
- Path 3: If tier = "C" → add to CRM + add to drip sequence

Step 4: CRM entry (see HubSpot section below)

- Add the HubSpot module → "Create a Contact"
- Map the form fields + AI summary to HubSpot contact properties

Step 5: Email (see email tool section below) Step 6: Slack notification (for Tier A leads)

- Add the Slack module → "Send a Message"
- Channel: #leads or #sales
- Message: "🔥 Tier A lead: [Name] at [Company], [SqFt] sq ft [PropertyType] in [City]. Score: [Score]/100. [AI Summary]"

4. Click "Run once" to test with sample data
5. Toggle the scenario to "Active" and set it to run "Immediately" (webhook-triggered)

4. CRM — HubSpot Free

What it is: HubSpot CRM is where all your leads live after they submit the form. You can see every lead, their score, their property details, and the AI-generated summary — all in one place. It also has a deal pipeline view so you can track leads from "New" to "Audit Scheduled" to "Proposal Sent" to "Closed."

Why HubSpot Free: It's genuinely free forever, supports up to 1 million contacts, and has the best integration ecosystem. Make has a native HubSpot connector, so connecting them takes minutes. When you're ready for email automation and workflows, you can upgrade.

Cost:

- Free CRM: **\$0/month** — unlimited users, up to 1M contacts, deal pipeline, email tracking
- Starter (when you need more): **\$20/month per seat** — removes branding, adds basic automation
- You won't need to pay anything to start

Step-by-step setup:

1. Go to hubspot.com and sign up for free
2. Set up your contact properties (Settings → Properties → Create property):
 - Property Type (dropdown: Warehouse, Retail, Office, etc.)
 - Square Footage (number)
 - Utility Provider (dropdown: Duke, TECO, FPL)
 - Fixture Count (number)
 - AI Lead Score (number)
 - AI Lead Tier (dropdown: A, B, C)
 - AI Summary (multi-line text)
 - Estimated Savings (text)
3. Set up your deal pipeline (Sales → Deals → Edit pipeline):
 - Stages: New Lead → Audit Scheduled → Audit Complete → Proposal Sent → Negotiation → Won / Lost
4. In Make, connect the HubSpot module:
 - Click the HubSpot module → "Create a Connection"
 - Sign in to your HubSpot account and authorize Make
 - Map your form fields and AI response fields to the HubSpot properties you created

5. Email Sending — Instantly.ai or Loops

What it is: These are cold email / transactional email platforms. When Claude writes a personalized outreach email for a new lead, this tool actually sends it. They handle deliverability, warm-up, and tracking so your emails land in inboxes, not spam.

Instantly is better for cold outreach and follow-up sequences. **Loops** is better for transactional emails and drip campaigns. For lead follow-up, Instantly is the stronger choice.

Cost:

- Instantly Growth plan: **\$30/month** — 1,000 leads, 5,000 emails/month, unlimited accounts
- Loops Starter: **\$25/month** — 2,000 contacts, basic sending
- At your volume, either starter plan works

Step-by-step setup:

1. Sign up at instantly.ai
2. Connect your business email (you'll want a dedicated sending domain, like outreach@freeenergyconsultants.com)
3. Let the warm-up run for 2 weeks before sending real emails — this builds sender reputation
4. In Make, add the Instantly module or use an HTTP module to call Instantly's API
5. The AI-generated outreach subject line and body get passed from the Claude step directly into the email send step

Important: Always have a human review loop for the first few weeks. Set up the Make scenario to create a draft in Instantly rather than auto-sending, so you can review the AI-written emails before they go out. Once you trust the quality, switch to auto-send for Tier A leads.

6. Team Notifications — Slack

What it is: Slack is a team messaging app. When a high-priority lead comes in, you get an instant notification with the AI summary so you can respond fast.

Cost:

- Free plan: **\$0/month** — works fine for this use case
- Pro plan: **\$7.25/month per user** — if you need message history beyond 90 days

Step-by-step setup:

1. Create a Slack workspace at slack.com (or use your existing one)
 2. Create a channel called #leads
 3. In Make, add the Slack module and connect your workspace
 4. Configure it to post a formatted message with the lead's name, score, tier, property type, and AI summary
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7. Lead Enrichment (Optional) — Apollo.io

What it is: Apollo looks up public business data about your lead — company size, industry, LinkedIn profile, website, etc. This gives Claude more context for scoring and personalization.

Cost:

- Free plan: **\$0/month** — 60 mobile credits, 120 export credits per year
- Basic plan: **\$49/month per user** — 900 mobile credits, unlimited emails
- **This is optional for v1.** Your form already collects enough data for Claude to score and personalize. Add Apollo later when you want deeper enrichment.

When to add it: Once you're getting 100+ leads/month and want to prioritize based on company revenue, employee count, or tech stack.

Cost Summary Table

Tool	Plan	Monthly Cost	Purpose
Vercel	Pro	\$20	Host landing page + API proxy
Claude API	Pay-per-use	\$1-\$7	AI lead scoring + email writing
Make	Free → Core	\$0-\$9	Automation orchestration
HubSpot	Free CRM	\$0	Contact & deal management
Instantly	Growth	\$30	Email sending & deliverability
Slack	Free	\$0	Team notifications
Apollo	Free (optional)	\$0	Lead enrichment
Total		\$51-\$66/month	

For the absolute minimum viable version (MVP): Skip Instantly (use Gmail manually at first) and skip Apollo. Use Vercel free/hobby for testing. Total: **\$0-\$20/month** while you validate the workflow, then upgrade when leads start flowing.

Implementation Timeline

Week	Task
Week 1	Deploy landing page to Vercel. Set up Claude API key. Create HubSpot CRM with custom properties.
Week 2	Build the Make scenario: webhook → Claude → HubSpot → Slack. Test with sample leads.
Week 3	Set up Instantly, connect sending domain, start email warm-up. Review AI email quality.
Week 4	Go live. Monitor first 20 leads manually. Refine Claude prompt based on scoring accuracy.
Week 5+	Switch from draft-review to auto-send for Tier A. Add drip sequences for Tier B/C.

Key Accounts You'll Need to Create

1. **GitHub** (github.com) — free, stores your website code
 2. **Vercel** (vercel.com) — hosts your site
 3. **Anthropic Console** (console.anthropic.com) — Claude API access
 4. **Make** (make.com) — automation builder
 5. **HubSpot** (hubspot.com) — CRM
 6. **Slack** (slack.com) — notifications
 7. **Instantly** (instantly.ai) — email sending (when ready)
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FAQ

Do I need to know how to code? Minimally. You'll need to copy/paste the serverless function into Vercel and update a few lines in the form code. Everything else is no-code (Make, HubSpot, Slack, Instantly).

Can I use Airtable instead of HubSpot? Yes. Airtable works great as a lightweight CRM. The free plan includes 1,000 records and works well with Make. Use it if you want something simpler. HubSpot is better long-term because it has a proper deal pipeline and email tracking built in.

Can I use n8n instead of Make? Yes. n8n is open-source and free to self-host, but you need to run it on a server (DigitalOcean at \$6/month, for example). It's more powerful but has a steeper learning curve. Start with Make, switch to n8n later if costs become a concern.

What if I want to skip the AI scoring and just get leads into my CRM? That works too. Remove the Claude API step from your Make scenario and just send form data straight to HubSpot + Slack. You can add AI scoring later. The value of AI scoring grows as your lead volume grows.

How do I update the landing page content? Edit the HTML file, push to GitHub, and Vercel auto-deploys in seconds. If you want a visual editor, consider moving the landing page to Webflow (\$14-\$29/month) and keeping Vercel only for the form/API.